

The Architecture of *Grace*

Visual Anchor Charts

Autism-Adapted Edition · Teacher Supplement

BOOK THREE · THE INTERIOR

GRADES 6 · 7 · 8 · MODERATE SUPPORT

VISUAL-FIRST · CO-REGULATION · TRAUMA-INFORMED

Twelve printable anchor charts · one per page

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Before You Begin

What Book Three looks like at moderate support needs

This supplement is the most carefully scoped of the three Level 2 books — and we want to be honest with you about that scope.

Architecture of Grace · Book Three contains twenty-eight lessons organized around concepts requiring substantial abstract reasoning: **Mask vs. Mirror, the Compassionate Witness, Frankl's Choice-Agency, Mercy vs. Justice, the Grace Gap audit.** For Level 2 students at Grades 6–8, several are not developmentally appropriate. Pretending otherwise would be a disservice.

The multidisciplinary team made the following scope decisions:

What we kept and adapted (12 charts)

- **Mask vs. Mirror** — with the autistic burnout panel prominent. The most important chart in this book.
- **Shame vs. Guilt · Mean vs. Helpful Thoughts · When I Made a Mistake** — preserved as concrete first-then structures.
- **The Pause / Charitable Interpretation** — replaced with the "When Something Surprises Me" co-regulation routine.
- **Forgive ≠ Be Close Again** — Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation, with pattern guardrail.
- **Hard Person vs. Unsafe Person** — concrete observable criteria.
- **Asking for What I Need** — accommodation requests as a self-advocacy skill.
- **Crisis Resources (appears twice)** — with autism-specific panel. *Non-negotiable.*

What we chose to omit

- Compassionate Witness as a third-person voice; Choice-Agency Map with three rings; Mercy vs. Justice as a held tension; Grace Gap audit project; Letter of Release as a class writing task; several wrap-up lessons.

The result: twelve substantive charts at this support level — not 28 of declining quality.

A NOTE ON SCOPE

A student who is "Level 2" in one domain may be "Level 1" in another. If a Level 2 student's abstract reasoning is stronger than this supplement assumes, the Level 1 Book 3 may be more appropriate — or some combination. *Trust your read of the student in front of you.*

How I Have to LOOK · How I AM

Mask vs. Mirror · Performing vs. real

THE MASK · How I LOOK



What I show outside.
The performance.

THE MIRROR · How I AM



What is true inside.
The real me.

FOR AUTISTIC STUDENTS

Sometimes we try to LOOK like everyone else — even when it costs us a lot inside.

This room is a place where you can be how you ARE.

You can stim. You can look away. You can be quiet. You don't have to perform.

*Performing all the time is **tiring**.
You are allowed to **rest** from the performance.*

ADULT SCRIPT · WHAT THE GROWN-UP SAYS

"Sometimes we wear a mask — we look one way on the outside, even when we feel different on the inside. That is okay sometimes. But it is also tiring. In this room, you can show how you really are. You can stim. You can be quiet. You can take a break. You don't have to perform."

SPECIALIST NOTE · FOR THE TEACHER

This is the single most important chart in this book. For Level 2 autistic adolescents, masking pressure is real — often delivered through years of behavioral intervention that taught compliance and "quiet hands." The chart explicitly says: this room is different. The autistic burnout literature applies just as much to Level 2 students as to Level 1; possibly more, because they have fewer alternatives. Read the panel aloud as part of the lesson. Post Day 1. Keep all year.

What I DID · Who I AM

Guilt vs. Shame · Two different things

WHAT I DID



"I made a choice that didn't work."

Can be fixed.

"WHO I AM"



"I am bad."

Never true about a person.

*You did a thing.
You are **not** a bad thing.*

FOR ANYONE TOLD "YOU ARE BAD"

They are **wrong**.

Being autistic is not being bad.

Being different is not being broken.

ADULT SCRIPT · WHAT THE GROWN-UP SAYS

"There is a difference between what we DID and who we ARE. Mistakes are about what we did — they can be fixed. 'I am bad' is not true about anyone. Some people in your life may have told you something is wrong with WHO you are. They were wrong. You are still you."

SPECIALIST NOTE · FOR THE TEACHER

By Grade 6, Level 2 autistic students have often heard a decade of identity-level feedback — often delivered as well-meaning behavior correction. The plain-words box names this directly. Read aloud. Some students may have very still or absent reactions to this — note privately, follow Disclosure Protocol if needed.